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Final Preparation

The first 25 chapters of this book cover the technologies, protocols, design concepts, and considerations you need to understand for the CompTIA Network+ N10-009 exam. This chapter details a set of tools and a study plan to help you complete your preparation for the CompTIA Network+ N10-009 exam.

This brief chapter has three main sections. The first section lists exam preparation tools. The second section provides a suggested study plan you can use now that you have completed all the earlier chapters in this book. The third section describes some strategies that can help you to take and pass the exam.

Tools for Final Preparation

The digital resources associated with the book are available on the book's companion website. To access the companion website, follow these steps:

Step 1. Go to http://www.pearsonitcertification.com/register.

Step 2. Either log in to your account (if you have an existing account) or create a new account.

Step 3. Enter the ISBN of this book (9780135367889) and click **Submit**.

Step 4. Answer the challenge questions to validate your purchase.

Step 5. On your account page, click the **Registered Products** tab and then click the **Access Bonus Content** link.

NOTE You must access the companion website and register the book ISBN by December 31, 2027.

Resources available on the companion website include the following:

- Interactive glossary flash card application
- The Pearson Test Prep practice test software
- Video training on key exam topics
- Memory table review exercises and answer keys

- A study planner tool
- Your CompTIA Network+ certification exam voucher, which provides a 10% discount on the exam

Video Training

The companion website for this book makes available ten training videos that address a couple of the most misunderstood concepts in the CompTIA Network+ curriculum—specifically the OSI model and IP addressing:

- **Video 1:** Introduction to the OSI Model
- **Video 2:** Layer 1—The Physical Layer
- **Video 3:** Layer 2—The Data Link Layer
- **Video 4:** Layer 3—The Network Layer
- **Video 5:** Layer 4—The Transport Layer
- **Video 6:** Layers 5–7—The Upper Layers
- **Video 7:** IP Addressing—Part 1 (Binary Numbering Review)
- **Video 8:** IP Addressing—Part 2 (Basic Subnetting)
- **Video 9:** IP Addressing—Part 3 (Advanced Subnetting)
- **Video 10:** IP Addressing—Part 4 (Introduction to IPv6)

These training videos are presented by Kevin Wallace, who is a dear friend and industry great. You can find more of his great work at his training company website, https://www.kwtrain.com.

Memory Tables

Like most other Cert Guides from Pearson IT Certification, this book purposefully organizes information into tables and lists for easier study and review. Rereading these tables and lists can be very useful before the exam. However, it is easy to skim over tables without paying attention to every detail, especially when you remember having seen the table's contents when reading the chapter.

To help you more effectively learn the information in the tables throughout this book, the companion website provides two appendixes:

- Appendix B, "Memory Tables," lists partially completed versions of many of the tables in this book. You can open Appendix B and print the appendix. For review, you can attempt to complete the tables.

- Appendix C, "Memory Tables Answer Key," which is also a PDF, lists the completed tables so that you can check your answers. You can also just refer to the tables printed in the book.

End-of-Chapter Review Tools

Chapters 1–25 all have several features in the "Exam Preparation Tasks" and "Review Questions" sections at the end of the chapter. You might have already worked through these tools in each chapter. However, it can help to use them again as you make your final preparations for the exam.

Suggested Plan for Final Review and Study

This section lists a suggested study plan from the point at which you finish reading Chapter 25 until you take the CompTIA Network+ exam. You can ignore this plan, use it as is, or modify it to better meet your needs.

The plan involves these steps:

Step 1. **Review key topics.** You can use the table at the end of each chapter that lists the key topics of the chapter, or you can just flip through the pages looking for key topics icons.

Step 2. **Complete memory tables.** Open Appendix B on the companion website, print the entire appendix, and then complete the tables.

Step 3. **Study the "Review Questions" sections.** Go through the "Review Questions" section at the end of each chapter to identify areas in which you need more study. All of these questions are available to you in the Pearson Test Prep software. Simply select the **Book Questions** exam bank to run a practice exam using just these questions from the book.

Step 4. **Use the Pearson Test Prep (PTP) app to practice.** You can use the PTP app to study using a bank of unique, exam-realistic questions available only with this book. Run through the questions the first time in study mode and assess your areas of weakness. Then work through the questions again in practice exam mode to assess your exam readiness. Go through the questions a final time in flash card mode to really challenge yourself to answer the questions without being able to see the multiple-choice answers.

The database of questions used by the Pearson Test Prep app was created specifically for this book. You can use the Pearson Test Prep app either in study mode, practice exam mode, or flash card mode, as follows:

- **Study mode:** Study mode is most useful when you want to use the questions for learning and practicing. In study mode, you can select options such as randomizing the order of the questions and answers, automatically viewing answers to the questions as you go, and testing on specific topics.
- **Practice exam mode:** Practice exam mode presents questions in a timed environment, providing you with an exam-realistic experience. It also restricts your ability to see your score as you progress through the exam and view answers to questions as you are taking the exam. These timed exams not only allow you to study for the actual CompTIA Network+ exam but also help you simulate the time pressure that can occur during an exam.
- **Flash card mode:** Flash card mode simply removes the multiple-choice answers, challenging you to answer each question in your head, without the benefit of seeing the possible answers. Using this mode is a great way to drill on topics in which you are particularly weak. Note that in this mode, you will not be able to record questions as right or wrong, and a grade report is not available; you will have to assess yourself on your own when you view the correct answers.

When doing your final preparation, you can use study mode, practice exam mode, and flash card mode. However, after you have seen each question a few times, you are likely to remember the questions, and the usefulness of the exam database might decrease. Therefore, consider the following options when using the exam engine:

- Use the exam bank 1 question database for review. Use study mode to study the questions by chapter, just as with the other final review steps listed in this chapter. When you are ready to do final review, use the other exam bank that you have not seen before.
- Save the question database by not using it during your review of each part of this book so that you will not have seen the questions before. Then, use practice exam mode to simulate the exam.

Picking the correct mode from the exam engine's user interface is straightforward. The following steps show you how to move to the screen where you can select the mode:

Step 1. Click the **My Products** tab if you are not already in that screen.

Step 2. From the list of available products, select the product you want to use.

Step 3. Click the **Exams** button.

You can then choose study mode, practice exam mode, or flash card mode. When in study mode or flash card mode, you can further choose the book chapters, thus limiting the questions to those explained in the specified chapters of this book.

The PTP app also allows you to mark questions, thus creating a custom database of questions for topics on which you might need extra review. It also allows you to enter notes on questions and review those notes.

Strategies for Taking the Exam

Are you ready for some strategy tips for your Network+ exam attempt? This section provides several of them. Of course, you can apply many of these to other certification exams as well:

- You can use one of two overall strategies for scheduling your exam. One approach is to schedule for an exam slot when you are fully ready; this is my favorite approach. You might have to wait as much as a week if all of the exam slots at your desired time are full, but typically if you are near a large city, you can find a slot for the very next day. The other approach is to schedule for several months out and then study, study, study to be ready for the exam slot you booked. Some people need to use this strategy to avoid procrastinating. If you adopt this strategy, be sure to check into the cancelation or rescheduling policy just in case your life gets in the way of your studies!
- Schedule the exam for a time that works great for you. If you are not a morning person, do not schedule the exam for early morning! Instead, schedule the exam for a time slot that works for you, even if it means waiting an extra day or two.
- Plan for and get a good night's rest before the exam. Also be sure to eat a good meal (breakfast or lunch) before the exam. Drink plenty of water to stay hydrated. Your mind will perform better when your body has what it needs. With that said, be sure not to experiment the day of the exam. I have talked to students who decided to suddenly try consuming a bunch of caffeine before the exam. They had a terrible exam experience because they were doing something their bodies were not used to.
- Map out where the testing center is and ensure that you know how to get there and how long the trip takes. Of course, if you are testing at home, you do not have this to worry about. Instead, be sure to follow the test at home instructions provided to you. For more information about testing at home, visit https://www.pearsonvue.com and click the **Online Testing** tab.
- Have the proper identification required for the exam.

- Be ready at least 30 minutes before your exam time. Take a few moments to relax and take several healthy breaths to increase your ability to do well on the exam. You might want to use the restroom before taking the exam so that your focus can be in the correct place during the exam.
- Manage your time in the exam. It is hard to answer a question correctly if you have run out of time and never see that question! If you have questions that you are unsure about, or if there is a simulation or lengthy question that may take several minutes, consider marking that question for review and come back to it after you have had an opportunity to answer the other questions. Often, other questions will refresh your memory and provide insight into questions that you have previously marked for review.
- Get ready for the performance-based questions to be grouped together and to be near the front of the exam. CompTIA has stuck to this formula pretty consistently. Doing this gives the students a little better chance at proper time management because these performance-based questions tend to take a bit more time than the multiple-choice questions.
- Smile at questions that are puzzling to you. The exam may give you an opportunity to learn a couple new things, and smiling when you see a tricky question can assist you in staying positive while you continue to answer the other questions that you know. It is likely that you will want to mark any puzzling questions for review and come back to them.
- Use your scratch paper in the exam (or the digital notepad) to note the topics of questions that you are forced to take a best guess at. If you don't pass the exam, memorize this list of topics. These are areas you should spend extra time on in your preparation for your second (and hopefully final!) attempt. Focusing on these areas, repeat the preparation steps outlined in this chapter.
- Have fun with this process. If you are enjoying the journey, everything regarding this certification process will go much more smoothly.

Summary

The tools and suggestions listed in this chapter are designed with one goal in mind: to help you develop the skills required to pass the CompTIA Network+ exam. This book has been developed from the beginning to not just present you with a collection of facts but also to help you learn how to apply those facts. Regardless of your experience level before reading this book, it is my hope that the broad range of preparation tools and the structure of the book will help you pass the exam with ease. I wish you success with your exam and hope that our paths will cross again as you continue to grow in your networking career and certification endeavors.

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